

Complete Learning Material in Q&A Format

A. Meaning and Scope of Social Science

Q1. What is Social Science?

Answer: Social Science is the **systematic study of human society**. It studies how people live together, how governments work, how economies function, how the environment affects people, and how the past influences the present.

Q2. Why is Social Science called a systematic study?

Answer: It is called systematic because it studies society in an organised way. It uses **observation, evidence and logical reasoning** to understand social life.

Q3. What does Social Science try to understand?

Answer: Social Science tries to understand:

- why events happen,
- how people live together,
- how the environment influences life,
- how governments function,
- how economies operate, and
- how the past and present shape the world.

Q4. How is Social Science different from Physics, Chemistry and Biology?

Answer: Physics, Chemistry and Biology mainly study the **natural world**. Social Science studies **society, institutions, cultures and human interactions**.

Q5. What are institutions?

Answer: Institutions are organised systems or bodies that help society function, such as governments, schools and other public organisations.

Q6. Why are human beings dependent on one another?

Answer: Human beings live in societies and depend on others for food, transport, education, electricity, government services and many other needs.

Q7. What factors shape our lives according to Social Science?

Answer: Our lives are shaped by:

- the environment,
 - institutions that govern us,
 - economic activities,
 - traditions, and
 - ideas passed from one generation to another.
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B. Social Science in Everyday Life

Q8. How is the food we eat connected with Social Science?

Answer: Food may come from different regions. Before reaching us, it is harvested, processed, transported, bought and sold by many people. This involves geography, economics and social cooperation.

Q9. How are roads connected with Social Science?

Answer: Roads are planned and maintained by public authorities. This connects daily life with governance and public administration.

Q10. How is a school connected with Social Science?

Answer: A school works under educational policies and programmes made by governments and institutions.

Q11. How is electricity connected with different social systems?

Answer: Electricity is produced in power stations and supplied through a large network. Its production and distribution involve technology, government planning, resources and economic organisation.

Q12. What do simple daily activities depend upon?

Answer: Daily activities depend on:

- governance,
- economic production,
- social cooperation, and
- the natural environment.

Q13. Why do some people live in crowded cities while others live in scattered villages?

Answer: Such differences may result from geography, history, resources, institutions and human choices. Social Science studies all these factors together.

Q14. Why do different communities speak different languages and follow different traditions?

Answer: Such differences develop because societies are shaped by different historical, geographical and cultural experiences.

Q15. Why do some regions depend mainly on farming while others depend on industry or trade?

Answer: Different regions have different resources, environments, historical developments and economic opportunities. These factors influence the occupations of people.

Q16. Why are some regions more affected by floods than others?

Answer: Social Science examines geographical and environmental conditions to understand why some areas are more prone to floods.

Q17. Why does agriculture grow well in some regions but not in others?

Answer: Agricultural development is influenced by geographical and environmental conditions and the resources available in a region.

Q18. How does Social Science answer questions about society?

Answer: It uses:

- careful observation,
- evidence, and
- logical reasoning.

C. Understanding Change in Society

Q19. How can we study changes in our locality?

Answer: We can observe changes in transport, housing, education, technology or the environment and ask:

- What was the situation earlier?
- What has changed?
- What caused the change?
- How has it affected people?

Q20. Why is studying local change useful?

Answer: It helps us understand how people, places and systems are connected. It also helps us see society as one connected whole rather than separate pieces.

D. Society Through Time and Traditions

Q21. Has human society always been the same?

Answer: No. Human society has changed greatly over thousands of years.

Q22. How did early human communities survive?

Answer: Early human communities depended directly on nature for survival.

Q23. What major changes gradually took place in early societies?

Answer: People gradually learned to:

- grow crops,
- domesticate animals,
- build settlements,
- develop tools,
- exchange goods, and
- organise systems of governance.

Q24. How did settlements change over time?

Answer: Villages developed into towns, and towns later grew into cities.

Q25. What transformed human ways of life over time?

Answer: New ideas, inventions and cultural exchanges gradually changed human life.

E. Indian Knowledge Traditions

Q26. What qualities were valued by early Indian thinkers?

Answer: Early Indian thinkers valued:

- discussion,
- questioning,

- logical reasoning,
- observation,
- reflection, and
- dialogue.

Q27. What are the Pañchamahābhūtas?

Answer: Pañchamahābhūtas means the **five great elements**. They are:

- Earth — Pṛithvī
- Water — Āpaḥ
- Fire — Agni
- Air — Vāyu
- Space — Ākāśha

Q28. What does the idea of Pañchamahābhūtas explain?

Answer: It explains nature as an **interconnected system** in which human life is also a part.

Q29. How is the idea of Pañchamahābhūtas connected with Social Science?

Answer: It helps explain how the environment influences:

- settlements,
- occupations,
- architecture,
- food habits, and
- health practices.

Q30. What does “vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam” mean?

Answer: It means “**the world is one family.**”

Q31. What idea is expressed by vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam?

Answer: It expresses the idea that human societies across different regions and cultures are interconnected and dependent on one another.

Q32. Why is interdependence important in Social Science?

Answer: Social Science studies how people, regions and societies interact and depend on one another.

F. Arthaśhāstra and Early Thinking About Governance

Q33. What was the main idea behind early Indian thinking about governance?

Answer: Political authority was linked with **public welfare** and **ethical responsibility** (moral duty).

Q34. What is the Arthaśhāstra?

Answer: The Arthaśhāstra is an ancient work attributed to **Kauṭilya**. It was composed about 2,300 years ago.

Q35. What subjects were discussed in the Arthaśhāstra?

Answer: It discussed:

- administration,
- economic management,
- taxation, and
- duties of rulers towards the people.

Q36. What does the Arthaśhāstra show about ancient India?

Answer: It shows that organised and systematic thinking about governance and the economy existed long before modern academic subjects developed.

G. How Social Scientists Work

Q37. How do modern social scientists study society?

Answer: They:

- observe people’s lives,
- conduct interviews,
- conduct surveys,
- examine documents, and
- compare different times and places.

Q38. Why do social scientists use many different sources?

Answer: They use many sources so that their explanations are supported by evidence and are more reliable.

Q39. What does Social Science explain about continuity and change?

Answer: It explains what continues over time and what changes. It also shows how the past shapes the present and how present actions influence the future.

Q40. What does “continuity” mean?

Answer: Continuity means something that continues or remains over a long period.

H. Social Science as a Group of Disciplines

Q41. Why can no single subject fully explain human society?

Answer: Human society is complex. A single event can affect the environment, economy, politics, society and culture at the same time.

Q42. Explain the example of drought given in the chapter.

Answer: A drought can affect:

- crops — environmental effect,
- farmers’ income — economic effect,
- government relief — political effect,
- migration to cities — social effect,
- traditional ways of dealing with shortage — cultural effect.

Q43. What does the drought example prove?

Answer: It proves that different parts of society are connected. Therefore, we need different Social Science disciplines to understand a situation fully.

Q44. What are the four main Social Science disciplines studied in Grades 9–10?

Answer: They are:

1. Geography
2. History
3. Political Science
4. Economics

Q45. What other subjects are included in the wider Social Science family?

Answer: Sociology, Philosophy, Anthropology and Psychology are also part of the broader Social Science family.

Q46. What does Geography mainly study?

Answer: Geography studies the Earth, its environments and the relationship between people and their surroundings.

Q47. What does History mainly study?

Answer: History studies the human past and explains how societies change over time.

Q48. What does Political Science mainly study?

Answer: Political Science studies governance, power, and the rights and responsibilities of citizens.

Q49. What does Economics mainly study?

Answer: Economics studies how societies produce, distribute and use resources to meet their needs.

Q50. Why are all four disciplines connected?

Answer: They ask different questions about society, but together they provide a **holistic** (complete and connected) understanding of human life.

I. Geography

Q51. What is Geography?

Answer: Geography studies the location and distribution of places, objects, materials and people. It also studies the relationship between people and their surroundings.

Q52. What two major parts of the world does Geography study?

Answer: Geography studies:

- physical features of the Earth, and
- human communities living on the Earth.

Q53. What main questions does Geography ask?

Answer: Geography asks:

- Where is something located?
- Why is it located there?

- How do places affect one another?

Q54. What is meant by a spatial perspective?

Answer: Spatial perspective means studying **location and the importance of location**.

Q55. What is meant by a temporal perspective?

Answer: Temporal perspective means studying **change over time**.

Q56. Why is Geography called a holistic discipline?

Answer: Geography combines spatial and temporal perspectives and uses ideas from both natural sciences and social sciences.

Q57. Which natural sciences support Geography?

Answer: Geography draws knowledge from Physics, Chemistry and Biology.

Q58. Which Social Science subjects support Geography?

Answer: Geography also draws knowledge from Political Science, Economics and History.

Q59. How did India's location influence its historical contacts?

Answer: India's geographical position and the long coastline of the Indian peninsula helped it develop contacts with Africa, Europe and Southeast Asia.

Q60. What tools are used in Geography?

Answer: Geography uses:

- maps,
- globes,
- atlases,
- Geographical Information System or GIS,
- infographics, and
- other instruments.

Q61. What is GIS?

Answer: GIS stands for **Geographical Information System**. It is one of the tools used to study geographical information.

Q62. What is the NCERT School Bhuvan portal used for?

Answer: It can be used to explore and map one's own village or city.

J. History

Q64. What is History?

Answer: History is the study of the **human past**. It helps us understand people's experiences, values and changes over time.

Q65. Can the past be understood in only one way?

Answer: No. The chapter says that there are different ways to interpret the past and pass cultural values from one generation to another.

Q66. What is the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition?

Answer: It is one of Bharat's oldest traditions of preserving cultural memory through stories.

Q67. What did the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition do besides giving historical information?

Answer: It gave cultural meaning to events and people and strengthened important ideals and values.

Q68. How can historical traditions differ?

Answer: Some traditions focus on moral and philosophical understanding, while others give greater importance to documentary verification.

Q69. What is modern historiography?

Answer: Modern historiography means the modern method of studying and writing history. It increasingly depends on **empirical evidence** and scientific methods.

Q70. What is empirical evidence?

Answer: Empirical evidence means information collected through **actual observation or experimentation**.

Q71. Which scientific methods are used in modern historical study?

Answer: These include:

- human genetics,
- carbon-14 dating,
- archaeology, and

- other scientific methods.

Q72. What types of sources are used to study history?

Answer: Historians use many sources, such as:

- travelogues,
- memoirs,
- correspondence,
- genealogical records,
- folklore,
- oral traditions,
- revenue documents, and
- archaeological remains.

Q73. What is a travelogue?

Answer: A travelogue is a written account of a person's travels.

Q74. What is a memoir?

Answer: A memoir is a written account of a person's memories and experiences.

Q75. What does correspondence mean?

Answer: Correspondence means letters or written communication exchanged between people.

Q76. What are genealogical records?

Answer: Genealogical records are documents that trace family lineage (family line) and ancestry. They may record births, marriages, deaths and relationships between generations.

Q77. What are archaeological sources?

Answer: Archaeological sources are material remains used to study the past.

Q78. Give examples of archaeological sources.

Answer: Examples include:

- monuments,
- buildings and other structures,
- excavated sites,
- artefacts,
- objects,
- sculptures, and
- paintings.

Q79. How are archaeological sources analysed?

Answer: They may be studied with scientific instruments and laboratory testing.

K. Visual Sources Shown in the Chapter

Q80. What examples of literary sources are shown on page 7?

Answer: Page 7 shows:

- a Sāṃaveda manuscript in the National Museum, New Delhi, and
- a traditional palm-leaf manuscript of the Tirukkural, an ancient Tamil text of ethical wisdom.

Q81. What examples of archaeological sources are shown on page 7?

Answer: The page shows:

- a terracotta figurine from the Sindhu-Sarasvatī Civilisation, and
- a sculpture of Viṣṇu from the 12th century CE.

Q82. What is an epigraphic source?

Answer: An epigraphic source is a historical source containing inscriptions (written records) on durable materials such as stone, rock or metal plates.

Q83. What information can epigraphic sources provide?

Answer: They can provide direct evidence about:

- past events,
- rulers,
- administration, and
- society.

Q84. What examples of epigraphic sources are shown in the chapter?

Answer: The chapter shows:

- a Brahmi inscription on part of a Gupta-period pillar, and

- a Kannada inscription of Emperor Krishnadeva Raya at the Prasanna Virupaksha Temple in Hampi.

Q85. What is a numismatic source?

Answer: A numismatic source is a historical source made up of coins, currency or medals.

Q86. What can coins tell historians?

Answer: Coins can provide information about:

- the economy,
- chronology (order of events in time),
- rulers,
- trade,
- political boundaries, and
- culture.

Q87. What features of coins do historians examine?

Answer: Historians examine their:

- metal content,
- inscriptions, and
- symbols.

Q88. What examples of coins are shown on page 8?

Answer: The page shows:

- a coin issued by King Samudragupta in the 4th century CE, and
- a Mughal coin from Jahangir's reign showing the zodiac sign Sagittarius.

L. Political Science

Q91. What is Political Science?

Answer: Political Science is the study of governance and power. It explains how power is distributed, how decisions are made and how policies are implemented.

Q92. What institutions does Political Science study?

Answer: It studies:

- constitutions,
- governments, and
- institutions of the State.

Q93. What other areas are studied in Political Science?

Answer: It also studies:

- social movements,
- nation building,
- foreign policy, and
- the ways power is exercised, shared and controlled.

Q94. What does the Panchayati Raj system show about democracy?

Answer: Panchayati Raj gives citizens a voice in local development planning. It is an example of **grassroots democracy** (democracy operating at the local level).

Q95. Does political power exist only in government institutions?

Answer: No. Political power can also exist in social relationships, customs and ideas about legitimacy (accepted right to rule).

Q96. What does the study of politics tell us about society?

Answer: It helps us study social hierarchies, struggles and efforts to create more effective and accountable governance.

M. Early Indian Political Thought

Q97. Was politics treated as a completely separate subject in early India?

Answer: No. Politics was closely connected with morality, economic well-being and duties of rulers.

Q98. What is dharma in the context of the chapter?

Answer: Dharma means **moral duty**.

Q99. What does artha mean here?

Answer: Artha refers to **economic well-being**.

Q100. What is rājadharmā?

Answer: Rājadharmā means **the duties of the ruler**.

Q101. Which ancient texts discussed political ideas?

Answer: The chapter mentions:

- Vedas,
- Upaniṣads,
- Purāṇas,
- Mahābhārata,
- Śhukranīti, and
- Arthaśhāstra.

Q102. What political ideas were discussed in early Indian texts?

Answer: They discussed:

- justice,
- authority,
- social order,
- responsibilities of rulers,
- responsibilities of citizens,
- governance,
- law, and
- ethical leadership.

Q103. Why is the Arthaśhāstra important in Political Science?

Answer: It is described as a foundational text on politics and administration.

Q104. What matters of government were explained in the Arthaśhāstra?

Answer: It explained:

- how a state should be governed,
- how taxes should be collected,
- how the army should work, and
- how rulers should ensure people's welfare.

Q105. What was the main nature of Indian political thought?

Answer: It followed a **holistic approach** by connecting politics with economics, society, morality and defence.

Q106. How was political power viewed in this tradition?

Answer: Power was seen as a **responsibility**, not simply as a privilege.

Q107. How are ancient political ideas connected with modern Panchayati Raj?

Answer: Ancient ideas stressed public welfare and responsible government. Panchayati Raj similarly promotes local self-government and public participation.

N. Economics

Q109. What is Economics?

Answer: Economics studies how individuals and societies use **limited resources** to meet their needs.

Q110. What basic economic activities does Economics study?

Answer: It studies how goods and services are:

- produced,
- exchanged, and
- distributed.

Q111. How does Economics affect everyday life?

Answer: Economics affects the food we eat, clothes we wear, jobs people do and services people use.

Q112. Who makes economic decisions?

Answer: Economic decisions are made by:

- consumers,
- producers, and
- governments.

Q113. What decisions do consumers make?

Answer: Consumers decide what they want to buy.

Q114. What decisions do producers make?

Answer: Producers decide what to produce and how much to produce.

Q115. What decisions do governments make in the economy?

Answer: Governments make policies to balance goals such as:

- growth and stability, and
- efficiency and fairness.

Q116. Is Economics only about money and markets?

Answer: No. Economics also deals with:

- well-being,
 - equity (fair sharing), and
 - justice.
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O. India's Economic Journey

Q117. What was India's economic position for many centuries?

Answer: India was one of the world's leading economies and an important centre of trade, industry and maritime activity.

Q118. What effect did colonial rule have on India's economy?

Answer: Colonial rule caused:

- widespread poverty,
- repeated famines, and
- decline of traditional industries.

Q119. What did India begin doing after independence?

Answer: India began rebuilding its economy.

Q120. What economic progress has India made in recent decades according to the chapter?

Answer: India has made progress through:

- better infrastructure,
- expansion of education,
- growth of technology,
- reduction in poverty, and
- increase in life expectancy.

Q121. What economic challenges still remain?

Answer: Important challenges include:

- increasing incomes, and
- ensuring that the benefits of growth reach all sections of society.

Q122. Why is economic development an important national goal?

Answer: Economic development can improve people's lives, increase opportunities and help ensure that resources and benefits are shared more fairly. The chapter therefore calls it a central national goal.

Q123. What is sustainable growth?

Answer: Sustainable growth means meeting present needs without reducing the ability of future generations to meet their own needs.

P. Why Should We Study Social Science?

Q125. Why is Social Science useful in ordinary life?

Answer: It helps us understand how systems around us developed, how they work and how they affect different groups of people.

Q127. Why are there many languages, customs and occupations within the same country?

Answer: These differences result from geographical, historical, cultural and economic factors.

Q128. How does understanding diversity help society?

Answer: It builds respect and cooperation among different communities.

Q129. How does Indian culture connect diversity with unity?

Answer: Indian culture provides an underlying unity that connects different communities and helps create a sense of belonging and shared identity.

Q130. Why is Social Science important in a democracy?

Answer: It helps citizens understand laws, rights, responsibilities, governments and decision-making. This prepares them to participate responsibly in civic life.

Q131. What does civic life mean?

Answer: Civic life means taking part responsibly in the public and community life of a society.

Q132. How does Social Science improve problem-solving?

Answer: It teaches us to ask informed questions about the causes, effects and possible solutions of social problems.

Q133. What social challenges are mentioned in the chapter?

Answer: The chapter mentions:

- environmental protection,
- public health,
- employment, and
- urban growth.

Q134. How does Social Science connect the past, present and future?

Answer: It helps us understand how past decisions shaped the present. This knowledge helps us make better decisions for the future.

Q. The Future of Social Science**Q135. Why is Social Science becoming more important today?**

Answer: Society is changing rapidly because of:

- new technologies,
- expanding cities,
- environmental concerns,
- migration, and
- global connections.

Q136. What skills are needed to understand these social changes?

Answer: We need:

- careful observation,
- questioning,
- examination of evidence, and
- recognition of connections.

Q137. What major future problems can Social Science help societies address?

Answer: It can help with:

- climate change,
- sustainable development,
- social harmony, and
- fair use of resources.

Q138. How can Social Science help with new technologies?

Answer: It can help guide the responsible use of new technologies and help communities adjust to changing conditions.

Q139. What type of citizen does Social Science aim to develop?

Answer: It aims to develop informed and thoughtful citizens who can take part in shaping society while supporting national unity and cultural traditions.

R. Two-Year Social Science Learning Journey**Q140. Why does the chapter call Social Science “a window into the world”?**

Answer: Because Social Science helps students understand the past, the present and their own role in shaping the future.

Q145. What contemporary challenges will students study?

Answer: They will study:

- environmental sustainability,
- social diversity,
- citizens' rights and responsibilities,
- technology, and
- global connections.

Q146. What skills should students develop through Social Science?

Answer: Students should learn to:

- analyse evidence,
- compare perspectives,
- connect the past, present and future,

- think independently, and
- act responsibly.

Q149. What is the larger purpose of studying Social Science?

Answer: It helps students learn from the past, analyse the present and imagine a better future. It also develops independent thinking and responsible behaviour.

S. Important Comparisons

Q150. Differentiate between Natural Sciences and Social Science.

Natural Sciences	Social Science
Study the natural world.	Studies human society.
Include Physics, Chemistry and Biology.	Includes Geography, History, Political Science and Economics.
Focus mainly on natural processes.	Focuses on people, institutions, culture and human interaction.

Q151. Differentiate between Geography and History.

Geography	History
Studies places, environments and people.	Studies the human past.
Asks where things are and why they are there.	Asks how societies changed over time.
Studies location and human-environment relations.	Studies experiences, events and developments of the past.

Q152. Differentiate between Political Science and Economics.

Political Science	Economics
Studies governance and power.	Studies use of limited resources.
Studies governments, institutions and citizens.	Studies production, exchange and distribution.
Focuses on decisions and public authority.	Focuses on consumers, producers and economic policies.

Q153. Differentiate between literary and archaeological sources.

Literary Sources	Archaeological Sources
Mainly contain written or oral information.	Consist of physical remains of the past.
Examples include manuscripts, memoirs and travelogues.	Examples include monuments, artefacts and sculptures.
Help us understand ideas, experiences and records.	Help us study material evidence of past societies.

Q154. Differentiate between epigraphic and numismatic sources.

Epigraphic Sources	Numismatic Sources
Inscriptions on durable materials.	Coins, currency or medals.
May be found on stone, rock or metal plates.	Studied through metal, symbols and inscriptions.
Tell us about rulers, administration and society.	Tell us about rulers, economy, trade, chronology and culture.

U. Cause-and-Effect Questions

Q155. Why did villages gradually develop into towns and cities?

Answer: Human societies became more organised. People learned agriculture, domesticated animals, developed tools, exchanged goods and created systems of governance. These developments gradually changed settlements.

Q156. Why did India historically become a centre of global interaction?

Answer: India's geographical location and its long coastline helped create contacts with Africa, Europe and Southeast Asia.

Q157. Why did colonial rule weaken India's economy?

Answer: According to the chapter, colonial rule disrupted India's earlier economic progress and led to poverty, famines and decline of traditional industries.

Q158. Why should governments balance growth with fairness?

Answer: Economic growth alone is not enough. Its benefits should reach different sections of society fairly.

Q159. Why is sustainable development necessary?

Answer: Resources must be used so that present needs are met without harming the ability of future generations to meet their needs.

V. Conceptual “Why” Questions

Q160. Why is Social Science not simply a collection of four separate subjects?

Answer: Because real-life problems often involve geography, history, politics and economics at the same time. The disciplines are connected and together explain society more completely.

Q161. Why is evidence important in Social Science?

Answer: Evidence helps social scientists develop explanations that are based on facts and observations instead of guesswork.

Q162. Why should a student observe political issues around them?

Answer: Political Science becomes more meaningful when students connect ideas such as governance and power with real issues around them.

Q163. Why is studying diversity important in India?

Answer: It helps us understand why different languages, customs and occupations exist. It also develops respect, cooperation and a sense of shared identity.

Q164. Why should Social Science students ask questions instead of only memorising answers?

Answer: Social Science aims to develop observation, reasoning, evidence-based thinking and independent judgement.

W. CBSE Competency-Based Questions

Q165. A farmer’s village faces a long drought. Crop production falls. Farmers earn less money. Some families move to a nearby city. The government starts a relief programme. Which branches of Social Science are involved? Explain.

Answer: Several branches are involved:

- **Geography:** studies the drought and environmental conditions.
- **Economics:** studies crop loss and falling income.
- **Political Science:** studies government relief programmes.
- **Social aspects:** migration changes the lives of families and communities.

This shows why a social problem must be studied from different viewpoints.

Q166. A new highway is built near a village. Shops open, travel becomes faster and some farmland is converted into buildings. How can a Social Science student study this change?

Answer: The student can ask:

- What was the area like before?
- What changed after the highway was built?
- Why did the change happen?
- How did it affect farmers, shopkeepers and travellers?

The student can use observation, interviews and other evidence.

Q167. A city government wants to control pollution but industries fear that strict rules may reduce production. Which two Social Science areas are especially connected with this issue?

Answer:

Political Science is involved because government policies and decisions are being made.

Economics is involved because production, growth and economic effects are being considered.

Q168. A historian finds an old coin with the name of a ruler, symbols and metal markings. What kind of source is it? What can be learned from it?

Answer: It is a **numismatic source**. It may provide information about the ruler, economy, trade, chronology, political boundaries and culture.

Q169. A stone pillar contains an old royal order. What type of historical source is it?

Answer: It is an **epigraphic source** because the record is inscribed on durable material such as stone.

Q170. A researcher studies an old temple, a sculpture, a coin and a handwritten manuscript. Which kinds of historical sources are being used?

Answer: The temple and sculpture are archaeological sources. The coin is a numismatic source. The handwritten manuscript is a literary source.

Q171. A village allows local residents to participate in decisions about roads, drinking water and development work. Which political idea does this show?

Answer: It shows **grassroots democracy and local self-governance**, like the Panchayati Raj system.

Q172. A producer has limited raw materials and must decide whether to produce 500 or 1,000 units. Which branch of Social Science studies such a decision?

Answer: Economics studies this decision because it deals with how limited resources are used and how much producers decide to produce.

Q173. A country achieves rapid economic growth, but most benefits reach only a small group. What concern from this chapter arises?

Answer: The concern is **equity and fairness**. Economic growth should benefit different sections of society, not only a few people.

Q174. A government uses all its natural resources very quickly to increase present income. Why may this be a problem?

Answer: It may harm future generations. Sustainable growth requires meeting present needs without reducing the ability of future generations to meet their needs.

X. Assertion–Reason Questions

Q175. Assertion: Social Science is not a single discipline.

Reason: Human society is complex and must be studied from different perspectives.

Answer: Both Assertion and Reason are correct, and the Reason correctly explains the Assertion.

Q176. Assertion: Geography studies only mountains, rivers and climate.

Reason: Geography also studies human communities and their relationship with the environment.

Answer: The Assertion is false, but the Reason is true. Geography studies both physical features and human societies.

Q177. Assertion: Modern historians depend only on written documents.

Reason: Modern historiography also uses archaeology, genetics and carbon-14 dating.

Answer: The Assertion is false, but the Reason is true.

Q178. Assertion: Political power exists only inside Parliament and government offices.

Reason: Political power may also operate through social relationships, customs and ideas of legitimacy.

Answer: The Assertion is false, but the Reason is true.

Q179. Assertion: Economics is concerned only with money.

Reason: Economics also studies well-being, fairness and justice.

Answer: The Assertion is false, but the Reason is true.

Q180. Assertion: Social Science helps people become responsible citizens.

Reason: It helps people understand rights, responsibilities, governments and public decisions.

Answer: Both Assertion and Reason are correct, and the Reason correctly explains the Assertion.

Y. Higher-Order Thinking Questions

Q181. Why can the same event be studied differently by a geographer, historian, political scientist and economist?

Answer: Each discipline asks different questions. A geographer may study location and environment. A historian may study how the situation developed over time. A political scientist may study government decisions and power. An economist may study resources, incomes and production. Together, their views give a complete understanding.

Q182. How does the statement “the world is one family” connect with modern Social Science?

Answer: Modern societies are connected through regions, cultures and global interactions. The idea of *vasudhaiva kutumbakam* expresses this interdependence, which Social Science also studies.

Q183. Why is knowing the past useful for making decisions about the future?

Answer: Past decisions have shaped present conditions. By understanding their results, we can make wiser decisions and avoid repeating harmful choices.

Q184. Why does the chapter connect political power with responsibility?

Answer: Early Indian political thought linked authority with morality, public welfare and duties of rulers. Therefore, power was seen as something to be used responsibly, not simply as a privilege.

Q185. How can Geography help us understand economic activity?

Answer: Geography explains how location, environment, landforms and other geographical features influence where people live and what economic activities they carry out.

Z. Source-Based / Case-Based Questions

Q186. Read the situation:

A family eats rice grown in another state. The rice is transported by trucks using public roads. It is sold in a local market. Electricity is used to store and process it.

Which aspects of Social Science can be seen here?

Answer:

The situation shows:

- Geography through movement between regions.
- Economics through production, transport, buying and selling.
- Political Science through public roads and infrastructure.
- Social cooperation through the work of many people.

This shows that daily life depends on many connected systems.

Q187. Read the situation:

A region has poor rainfall for several years. Farming becomes difficult. Farmers lose income. Some people move to cities. The government gives financial support.

What does this case teach us about Social Science?

Answer: It teaches us that one event can have environmental, economic, social and political effects. Therefore, society must be studied through several disciplines together.

Q188. Read the situation:

A student finds an inscription on a stone wall naming a king and describing a tax order.

What type of source is this, and what information may it provide?

Answer: It is an epigraphic source. It may provide information about the ruler, taxation, administration and society.

Q189. Read the situation:

A government wants high economic growth but also wants poor families to benefit from development.

Which two economic goals is the government trying to balance?

Answer: It is trying to balance **growth with fairness**. Economics studies how governments balance such goals.

AA. Important Difficult Words**Q190. What does “interconnected” mean?**

Answer: Interconnected means linked with one another.

Q191. What does “interdependence” mean?

Answer: Interdependence means people, places or systems depending on one another.

Q192. What does “holistic” mean?

Answer: Holistic means studying something as a complete and connected whole.

Q193. What does “governance” mean?

Answer: Governance means the process of making decisions and managing public affairs.

Q194. What does “legitimacy” mean?

Answer: Legitimacy means the accepted or recognised right to exercise authority.

Q195. What does “equity” mean?

Answer: Equity means fairness in the distribution of opportunities and benefits.

Q196. What does “chronology” mean?

Answer: Chronology means arranging events in the order in which they happened.

Q197. What does “artefact” mean?

Answer: An artefact is an object made or used by people in the past.

Q198. What does “empirical” mean?

Answer: Empirical means based on actual observation or experiment.

Q199. What does “sustainable” mean?

Answer: Sustainable means able to continue for a long time without harming resources needed in the future.

Q200. What does “grassroots democracy” mean?

Answer: Grassroots democracy means people directly participating in government at the local level, such as through Panchayati Raj.